REBUTTAL TO ARGUMENT IN FAVOR OF MEASURE M

The City of Clayton's government-requested 1% sales-tax hike shows indifference to the unique challenges our citizens face in their daily lives. In addition, the tax measure lacks transparency and does not address key infrastructure deficiencies.

Cost of Living Insensitivity

- Homeowner insurance policies are rising steeply due to Clayton's high fire-risk rating.
- Contractor costs for maintenance and mitigating fire risks around our homes drain family savings.
- Childcare and college costs are at record highs, crushing working families already hit by high housing expenses.

Flawed Financial Benchmarking and Deficits

- Pegging Clayton's small-town employee salaries to other city governments' rates ensures that future spending will continue upward, likely requiring more tax increases.
- Clayton's government has not identified total long-term funding needs for deferred infrastructure maintenance, such as for streets and sidewalks, other liabilities, and capital replacement needs.
- Raising taxes to fund staff salary increases — without an action plan to fix crumbling infrastructure — makes no fiscal sense and likely leads to future tax hikes.

Transparency and Tax Fatigue

- The City lacked recent, thorough tax-measure development engagement with working families, business owners, and professional groups.
- Voters face mounting financial burdens: around 35% of Clayton households saw significant increases in Geological Hazard Abatement District (GHAD) property tax fees last year, and the city's Landscape Maintenance District tax is up for renewal; yet a forever 1% sales tax increase is demanded.

Please vote No on Measure M, as it aggressively increases taxes on tangible purchases like cars, clothes, and electronics.

The undersigned proponent(s) or author(s) of the Rebuttal to the Argument In Favor of Measure M at the General Election for Contra Costa County, to be held on 11/3/26, hereby state this argument is true and correct to the best of (his/her/their) knowledge and belief.

1. Name, Title: **Marc Joffe**, President, Contra Costa Taxpayers Association

   Signature: Marc Joffe

2. Name, Title: **James Killoran**, Credit Union Supervisory Committee Chair, Clayton

   Signature: Jas Killo

3. Name, Title: **Allison Snow**, Retired Healthcare Executive, Clayton

   Signature:

4. Name, Title: **Roy Ashworth**, Retired Financial Analyst, Clayton

   Signature: Roy Ashworth

RELEASE FOR REBUTTAL ARGUMENT: AUTHORIZATION FOR ANOTHER PERSON OR PERSONS TO SIGN REBUTTAL ARGUMENT

I/We, Signer(s)/Filer(s) of the original ("**Primary**") **Argument Against** Measure M at the General Election for Contra Costa County to be held on November 3rd, 2026, hereby authorize the listed substitute persons to sign the **Rebuttal Argument** Against the Measure M in my/our stead.

1. Roy Asbworth to sign instead of Bill Calkins
   (Print name of **Rebuttal** Signer) (Print name of Primary Argument Signer)

   Bill Calkins Date 8/18/26
   (Signature of **Primary Argument Signer**)

2. _____ to sign instead of _____
   (Print name of **Rebuttal** Signer) (Print name of Primary Argument Signer)

   _____ Date _____
   (Signature of **Primary Argument Signer**)

3. _____ to sign instead of _____
   (Print name of **Rebuttal** Signer) (Print name of Primary Argument Signer)

   _____ Date _____
   (Signature of **Primary Argument Signer**)

4. _____ to sign instead of _____
   (Print name of **Rebuttal** Signer) (Print name of Primary Argument Signer)

   _____ Date _____
   (Signature of **Primary Argument Signer**)

5. _____ to sign instead of _____
   (Print name of **Rebuttal** Signer) (Print name of Primary Argument Signer)

   _____ Date _____
   (Signature of **Primary Argument Signer**)

Signature of FILER:_____ **Date:** _____